

Standard Operating Procedure (SOP)

Drake Application Support

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Drake Application Support

Scope: Drake Application

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1. Purpose

This SOP defines the process for managing, maintaining, and supporting the **Drake Application** across Numera systems. It outlines information required for first and second-level IT technicians to ensure consistent support, uptime, and user satisfaction.

2. Responsibilities

- **OnSite Engineer/ROC:** User onboarding, password resets, basic troubleshooting, log collection, and ticket updates.
 - **Server Support:** Application installation, upgrades, data migration, and escalation coordination with OEM (Drake Support / Beyond Cloud).
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3. Drake System Overview

- **Application Name:** Drake
 - **Deployment Type:** Client–Server model hosted on central Windows Server.
 - **Access Method:** RDP / RemoteApp from workstations.
 - **Licensing:** Per-firm / per-preparer license; managed via firm credentials and ERO configuration.
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4. User Onboarding Process

Objective: Provide secure and consistent Drake user account creation.

Steps: 1. Receive onboarding request from HR or manager. 2. Log in as Admin on Drake. 3. Navigate: Setup → Preparers and Users. 4. Create new user with format: FirstInitialLastname 5. Assign Firm → Global CFO LLC 6. Set PIN Signature: 22115. 7. Add

user to Security Group: *Preparer*. 8. Generate a temporary passcode, and share securely via email. 9. Advise user to change the passcode at first login.

5. Application Maintenance & Updates

Frequency: Periodic — typically every 2–3 days (or as Update Manager prompts).

Process: 1. Monitor for Update Manager pop-ups in Drake. 2. Schedule updates outside business hours. 3. Ensure all users are logged out before starting. 4. Run Update Manager and apply updates. 5. After update, open sample return files to confirm data integrity. 6. If failure or corruption occurs, escalate to vendor (Beyond Cloud / Drake Support).

Pre-update Checklist: Confirm full system backup available. - Verify adequate free disk space (>15% free). - Notify all users of maintenance window.

6. File Maintenance & Data Transfer

Used For: Annual migration, cleanup, or repair.

Menu Path: *Tools* → *File Maintenance*

Key Functions: Export Client Data - Import Client Data - Unlock Files - Delete Print Files - Verify Integrity

Year-to-Year Transfer Procedure: 1. Perform backup of previous year's data (C:\DrakeYY). 2. Launch new year version (e.g., Drake2026). 3. Run Transfer Data from Prior Year. 4. Validate transferred clients using sample records. 5. Document any failed transfers for vendor escalation.

7. Backup & Restore Procedure

Backup Location: Dedicated server directory or network share.

Daily Tasks: Ensure incremental backup runs successfully.

Before major update/migration: Take a full system snapshot + application data backup.

Restore Steps: 1. Stop Drake services / disconnect users. 2. Copy backup files to staging folder. 3. Restore into corresponding directory. 4. Validate by opening sample client files.

9. Vendor Support Escalation

Vendor: Drake Software

Details to share when raising ticket: Account/Firm ID (under *Setup* → *ERO Information*) - Affected Client IDs - Full Error Message and Screenshot - Timestamp and User Details

Typical Support Window: U.S. business hours (CST/EST).

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